

PIR - Sev 1- Goodwill voucher of \$100 auto applied for international orders from US site.

M&S Digital&Tech *Post Incident Review*



Incident/ Problem Reference: INC000090669693

Incident Date: 17/03/2025

PIR Date: 24/03/2025

Author: Nilesch Singh

Attendees: Webster, Charly Fitzgerald, Kerry Hawthorn, Elaine Natarajan, Srinivasan
 Ramanathan, Chokkanathan Prusty, Ranjan Sreejith, Vineetha RM Raju, Muthukumar D'Amora, Cristina
 Ravichandran, Ganesh Prabu

Technical Owner: Natarajan, Srinivasan Sreejith, Vineetha

👉 *Analyses the root cause and provide technical recommendations to prevent incident recurrence.*

👉 *Develop and oversee the implementation of an action plan to address the root causes.*

👉 *Work closely with cross-functional teams to gather information and insights.*

PIR Reviewer: Webster, Charly

👉 *Validates the root cause analysis, corrective actions, and preventive measures before signing off, ensuring alignment with business and operational standards.*

1. Incident Summary :

👉 *Provide a concise overview of the incident with brief update on issue, impact, root cause and resolution.*

Global-e reported huge spike in order volume for international as compared to the daily trend, upon investigation support team narrowed down the spike originating from USA market on the back of \$100 voucher getting applied automatically for all the orders irrespective of order value or customer.

Further investigation revealed this was due to a test promo "**test1303-3**" went accidentally live in prod (site-wide) on 14th night, minor spike in order volume from 15th onwards were observed, but on 17th Morning it was huge spike and 18-19k orders inflow within 6-7 hrs.

Caused impact as mentioned.

- Approx. 25k orders were taken for USA in the last 2 days whereas the normal order volume should have been 500-600.
- Nearly 19.9k Orders cancelled at Global-e, 4k orders EDC & 460 orders by Ollerton
- 1453 orders dispatched, 223 were delivered to customer will have financial impact ~£24k
- Goodwill to customer against cancellation will be additional loss (to be decided)

Incident was resolved by identifying and disabling the test promo which accidentally went live in production, further recovery actions were performed with the help of Global-e by holding the order inflow to fulfilment services and based on decision stop delivery (inflight) was initiated by Global-e in coordination with DHL.

Orders (~5k) got interfaced with fulfilment services and among ~3k were in awaiting dispatch status were cancelled by respective DC's (Donington & Ollerton). Based on discussions and advice from legal, ops decided to issue goodwill comms to the impacted customers impacted due to stop delivery recovery action.

2. Incident Chronology :

👉 Include a record of the data/time of key events. e.g. "07:36 Incident started, notified by ..." **keep fact based**".

17th March (Sev 2)

05:30 - Global-E reported the on the back of increased order volume and observing flat \$100 voucher getting applied irrespective of Order value.

05:35 - Support team engaged and started the investigation.

05:45 - Merchandising team was engaged to check the promotion details went live for the markets

05:55 - Support team further investigation with the promotion id to find the actual cause and found that the impact was limited to US Orders.

06:10 - Service leads were engaged

06:10 - Support team was able to narrow down to the actual promotion id causing the issue

06:15 - Team discussed internally and decided to be switched off the promotion to further limit the impact.

06:20 - No further orders were seen with the flat \$100 voucher promotion and issue was resolved.

06:25 - Monitoring, no further impact

Upgraded to Sev 1 (Recovery actions)

08:13 - Working on a recovery plan

08:14 - Stakeholder from global-e and international ops onboarded

08:15 - CDC WMS team was engaged to check the order status and feasibility to cancellation

08:30 - Update from Global-E, the orders were seen from Saturday and nearly 20k orders were seen, based on the observation it was mentioned by global-e there are orders currently on hold at global-e

08:37 - OMS and WMS team working on to get confirmation if any orders

08:45 - around 4k orders have gone to CDC for 21st March,

08:46 - Based on the stats OMS were able to confirm spike in the order volume 4.7 k

08:50 -  Ellis, Adrienne confirmed approx. 4.6 k orders have payment flag and showing country of origin as USA.

08:55 -  Kumar, Vipin shared the Global -E orders from 14th March for further analysis

08:56 -  Ramanathan, Chokkanathan to extract the orders line and promotion details to compare

09:01 -  Phillips, Neil Shared the order count for USA with CDC

Row Labels	Count of Or
USA	4600
15/03/2025	78
00	2
01	5
02	3
03	3
04	1
05	1
06	3
07	2
09	3
11	1
12	3
13	3
14	5
15	7
16	6
17	3
18	2
19	5
20	8
21	4
22	3
23	5
16/03/2025	1266
00	4
01	2
02	3
03	5
04	3
05	2
06	4
07	4
08	1
09	1
10	1
11	7
12	9
13	18
14	56
15	86
16	69
17	108
18	134
19	153
20	151
21	142
22	146
23	157
17/03/2025	3256
00	203
01	280
02	406
03	804
04	1111
06	451
07	1

09:08 -  Fitzgerald, Kerry to pick up with Tracey on the customers comms on the back of cancellations.

09:15 -  Fitzgerald, Kerry 687 orders dispatched, and, on the way, Tracey will connect with DPD and will try to get these cancelled.

09:16 -  Kumar, Vipin shared the order stats from 14th March

Row Labels	Count of ORDER_NO
Awaiting Despatch	4853
Cancelled	15
Despatched	465
Order Created	10
Grand Total	5343

09:20 -  Ellis, Adrienne and EDC order management team will check the internal status for awaiting dispatch orders and cancel them by nil pick

09:30 - **Summary of recovery actions**

1. 600 orders dispatched and on trailer, Global-e will coordinate with DHL and try to check the feasibility of stopping them getting delivered as they are in-flight. Returns will be processed.
2. Approx 5k orders are flowed through EDC, team will cancel all of them but 600 (point #1)
3. 19.9k of orders on hold at Global-e that will be cancelled

10:00 – EDC team completed the cancellation for the orders which were shown as awaiting dispatch. (point #2)

10:15 - OMS support confirmed about 1200 orders for EDC and approx. 400 orders for Ollerton still awaiting cancellation.

10:25 - Global-e is moving forward with cancellation and will be confirmed once orders on hold are cancelled.

11:30 - Global-e identified issues with refund for delivery charges on the back of cancellation of orders on hold at Global-e. Global-e team to find another way to proceed with cancellation and confirm.

11:40 - Recovery action in progress

1. 10 orders from OMS were cancelled -- Completed
2. Awaiting dispatch 1200 orders from EDC and 400 for Ollerton to be cancelled -- Awaiting response
3. 19.9 k order cancellation at global-e (on hold) -- in progress
4. Consolidate Comms on the back of cancellations -- planned

11:45 - Team regroup at 12:30 to further update on recovery actions.

13:15

- Current order status at EDC and Ollerton
- Pending 13k orders to be cancelled at global-e, ETA 2 hrs.
- Ollerton looking into cancelling 461 orders awaiting dispatch

13:45

- Ollerton ops to nil pick for those orders to systematic cancellation
- Total 1263 orders dispatched will be provided to Global-e to coordinate with DHL

15:45

- All 19.9k orders were cancelled and refund was triggered by Global-e
- 460 orders from Ollerton were nil picked to cancel
- Reconciliation will be performed based on SFCC extract
- Post reconciliation report will be shared with Global-e for customer comms.

18:30 - **Reconciliation summary**

- SFCC vs Global-e recon completed
 - 647 additional orders were found in SFCC Shipped or New status, shared with Global-e for further investigation
 - Reconciliation confirmed 19.9k orders held at Global-e got cancelled successfully. Customers comms will be triggered by Global-e
 - Nearly 6k orders interfaced with OMS (EDC & Ollerton) teams were able to cancel expect 1263 orders which got shipped
 - For shipped orders Global-e will coordinate with DHL

18th March

11:00 (**Regroup for recovery action**)

- As per advice from legal, orders for which customers received dispatch email will be fulfilled. Ops will be coordinating with Global-e.
- Nearly 1508 orders in dispatched status with AOV \$108, potential financial impact \$160 k
- Reconciliation of orders for dispatch vs stop delivery in progress to help decide further recovery action.

14:00 - **Recovery action (Final)**

- 1230 orders stopped delivery (cancelled) at Global-e
- 223 orders delivered to customer, potential revenue loss £24k
- Cancelled order details shared to ops to initiate customer comms.

16:10 - **Comms (recovery completed)**

- Goodwill email comms sent to all impacted customers (1230 cancelled orders)
- Cleanup and recovery steps completed.

16:20 - **Recovery completed and Incident Close**

3. Incident Resolution

 *The actions taken to restore services and mitigate impact.*

Resolution: As part of immediate resolution promotion causing the impact was identified and disabled. Post resolution full impact analysis was performed with the help of business ops and application teams for identifying recovery actions.

Recovery: Consolidation and reconciliation of data (order volume) spread across various systems was performed multiple times to identify, prioritize and bucket for the recovery actions as mentioned below.

	≡ Bucket's/Prioritization	≡ Recovery action
1	Orders held at Global-e and were still not interfaced with fulfilment services	Orders held and stopped interface were cancelled with the help of Global-e (19.9k)
2	Orders interfaces with fulfilment services across downstream system	Reconciliation across system was performed to understand orders volumes with status such as allocated, awaiting dispatch or dispatched (via Global-e hub or direct delivery)
3	Order processing status across various systems	Orders in allocated and awaiting dispatch were cancelled with the help of OMS and WMS.
4	Orders inflight via Global-e hub or Direct delivery to customers	Orders inflight were sent to Global-e to stop delivery (held at Ge-Hub or on its way via DHL)
5	Goodwill comms for impacted customers	Goodwill comms was sent to customers who received dispatch comms and orders were stopped delivery.

4. Root Cause

👉 Refers to the fundamental reason (s) why an incident occurred including problem description, analysis techniques, contributing factors, evidence with concise root cause statements

The root cause was attributed to an effort for reducing overall time by consolidating the inputs from promo planner and enabling automated promo setup for international sites. 14th Marc post deployment automation had an issue and was terminating without error.

To test if the fix was working in the staging environment, the team created a **NOE** request (**Goodwill voucher**) and tested it in staging environment. But the automation created a site-wide promotion instead of a promotion that is tagged to specific voucher codes. The team missed **deactivating the test NOE** request. This issue went undetected until 17th March morning until it was flagged by Global E.

5. Findings

👉 Refer to the key insights and conclusions drawn from the incident analysis - what went well/what went wrong highlighting gaps, failures, or inefficiencies.

5.1. Observability –

👉 Evaluating monitoring, logging, and alerting effectiveness in detecting the incident.

Alerts are in place for tracking the availability of pages but unfortunately order volume tracking isn't available. Internal discussions are in progress to determine the threshold levels. Based on the consistent trend of order volume, the team will define the threshold breach alerts can be raised to have proactive investigation.

5.2. Technical Challenges -

👉 Identifying system, infrastructure, or architectural issues that complicated resolution.

Tracking orders across multiple systems was challenging, reconciliation interfaced across multiple systems and obtaining order status of the orders was key element for arriving to recovery actions.

5.3. MIM involvement & impact assessment -

👉 Timely engagement of MIM and analysing the impact on business operations based on top 10 business processes

Gap in impact assessment.

Timely engagement of support teams and assessment following the shout raised by Global-e, although identifying the actual number of orders interfaced with fulfilment services or had an impact took slightly more time to start with recovery process.

5.4. Incident handling/ stakeholder management –

👉 Reviewing how teams collaborated to drive the incident to resolution and engaged with key stakeholders.

Tech-ops team was informed with impact and business comms were sent to all the stakeholders with impact statement and updates.

5.5. Business Communication –

👉 Clear, concise & timely communication to stakeholders, focusing on business impact and recovery actions.

Email & Text comms were sent to all the stakeholders as Sev 2, post full impact analysis with the help of Business ops, Tech Support teams and Service leads it was amended and upgraded to Sev-1 for Recovery action, due to the wider impact across multiple services

5.6. Supplier Engagement –

 Assessing the responsiveness and support provided by external vendors and internal product teams.

Incident Actions:

 Agree actions for each of the findings to prevent recurrence, strengthen system reliability & stability, and improve response efficiency for future incidents

	≡ Action	≡ Owner	📅 Due Date	≡ Remarks	🔖 Action Category
1	Identify the promo id causing issue and disable the promo to limit the impact		Mon, Mar 17, 2025		Permanent fix
2	Global-e to help stop delivery for the orders inflight, approx. 1453 orders		Mon, Mar 17, 2025		Solution & Recovery
3	Cancel orders not flown to M&S and are on hold at global-e (~19.9k)		Mon, Mar 17, 2025		Solution & Recovery
4	Approx ~5k order awaiting dispatch at DC's (EDC & Ollerton) to be cancelled		Mon, Mar 17, 2025		Solution & Recovery
5	Recovery action - Goodwill comms to impacted customers		Tue, Mar 18, 2025		Solution & Recovery

Actions as part of PIR

	≡ Action	≡ Owner	📅 Due Date	≡ Remarks	🔖 Action Category
1	Promotion Go Live Testing Process Review	 Natarajan, Srinivasan  Sreejith, Vineetha	Wed, Apr 30, 2025	- Review and ensure we have a comprehensive testing strategy - Develop test cases for wider use cases	Problem Avoidance
2	Identifying threshold for international orders and setup order tracking alerts for early warning.	 Ramanathan, Chokkanathan  Prusty, Ranjan	Fri, Apr 4, 2025	- Spikes - Can we do it per product level?	Problem Identification & Alerting

3	Daily report for Promotions live on the site?	 Sreejith, Vineetha	Tue, Apr 1, 2025	Make sure that is action is realistic and easy to do implementation. Maybe focus on Goodwill to start with?	Problem Identification & Alerting
4	Document standard recovery procedure across all systems.	 Ramanathan, Chokkanathan	Wed, Apr 2, 2025	Steps to consolidate and reconciliation data across application (Global-e, OMS & WMS)	Solution & Recovery
5					

Please refer to  Major_ Significant and Key Incident Tracker v1.0.xlsx for progress updates on Mitigations

<Mandatory participants: Put it in the meeting invite. >

Technical Details and Useful Documents: